

Spanish), or access the Family Filter page. For Web searches, set the options for displaying Web page information, the number of results to be returned per page, as well as browser language troubleshooting, should you have trouble with junk text being displayed.

Filters

AltaVista takes explicit content very seriously; by default, all family filtering against sexually explicit content is turned on. You can access it at <http://www.altavista.com/web/ffset>. You can choose the sort of filtering, whether restricted to image video and audio searches, for all or no searches. To enforce this, you can also protect the settings with a password.

AltaVista other searches

You can also search for more than just Web pages—think images, MP3 audio, video and news. Like the Yahoo! Directories, AltaVista too has a directory that you can use while searching for information. The Image Search has limited options, in terms of size and colour; however, it is very fast.

Cool tools

While not in the traditional realm of search, these tools will undoubtedly help you while you work on academic research.

Babelfish

AltaVista's coolest tool has got to be the Babel Fish Translation engine (<http://babelfish>.



Parlez-vous Français? Babelfish to the rescue...

altavista.com/babelfish/). It's reasonably accurate for general use, and lightning fast—be it a few lines of text, or an entire Web page. Enter the text in the blank text block (up to 150 words), or enter the URL of the Web page you want translated in the URL box, to get it translated to the language of your choice.

Converters

With AltaVista around, you don't have to dip into your pocket calculator for any quick mathematical conversions. Use AltaVista's quick converter functions to help you work between conversions—for example, entering 'convert 1 in' at the AltaVista search box will give you all the metric and imperial equivalents of 1 inch. So, you can convert time by using 'convert 45 sec'; convert speed by typing 'convert 1 mach'; do temperature conversions by entering 'convert 40 F'; convert weight using 'convert 170 lb'; do area conversions by enter 'convert 25 acre'; and do cooking volumes conversions by typing 'convert 1 gal'.

METACRAWLERS



Mamma

Claiming to be the mother of all search engines, Mamma (www.mamma.com) gives fast results for your queries. And it's got some pretty cool advanced features as well.

Search operators

Search operators make life a little simpler when you're searching through reams of pages to locate elusive information. In Mamma, you can use both mathematical operators, as well as Boolean

operators, to separate the wheat from the chaff. Here's how.

Refining your search

Mamma provides a pretty nifty service called 'Refine Your Search' that provides links to further sub-topics within a search. This feature provides more specific topic searches. If you input a general query, such as 'Linux kernel programming', the refine search options will include 'kernel programming' as well as 'Linux device drivers'.

Mamma search keywords

Keyword/ Symbol	Usage	Action
AND	watch AND casio	Looks for pages containing both the words (any order, anywhere in the page)
OR	watch OR casio	Looks for pages containing either of the words, if there are no results with both the words
NOT	watch NOT casio	Results served up contain 'watch', but not 'casio'
[+]	watch +casio	Looks for pages containing 'watch' and 'casio'.
[-]	watch -casio	Results will contain 'watch' but not 'casio'
" "	"casio watch"	Results will have the exact phrase 'casio watch' present, and in this order.



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